

Just DO it

My apologies to Nike, but when there's no better way to put it, I'm not going to waste time thinking of a new catchphrase.

For years now, perhaps without us realising it, we've been "doing" a lot less. I know, it's contrary to what you'd normally believe because it certainly feels like you're doing a lot more than any other generation before you, but you're not; not really.

I can hear you scream out "What rubbish!"

Yes, I know, I know, depending on whether you're a student or working professional, or even a retired person, you've seen your parents at work and know that although they were hard workers, they just got a lot less done in their lives. You get so much more done in a day than they ever did.

Thanks to technology, which has made our lives easier, you're certainly able to do things faster, perhaps even with better quality, but are you really doing as much or that much more?

The point I'm trying to make is, yes, we can pay off all our bills within seconds of receiving our salary, while our parents used to have to plan days ahead and stand in lines in the scorching sun to do the same thing. Yes, we can Google within seconds something that they'd have to refer to books for, and maybe have to travel to a library for. You order groceries online, while your mum still wants to go out and knock on fruit to check for ripeness, and bargain with the shop owners...technology has simplified the mundane.

So what exactly are you "doing" really? You have all this extra time (when compared to your parents) - what are you using that for? Oh sure, we know how to use gadgets and devices that they couldn't even imagine existed, but what do we do with said gadgets?

We consume a lot of entertainment - mostly videos, but also pictures, articles, slideshows and cartoons, among other things. We've all become chatterboxes! Everyone and his uncle can type an amazing amount of words a minute, and on tiny phone screens at that. Newton knows what we talk about, but we do a heck of a lot of it. There's a whole fight for net neutrality going on because people want to be able to charge

you for chat, amongst other things - that's how much we chat!

However, when was the last time you built something? From scratch. By yourself.

Even if your parents were not a part of the builder generation, their parents surely were. A door needs fixing, they'd yank out their tools and fix it. No calling a carpenter or plumber, or electrician. "What for?", they'd say, "It's a simple job".

I actually wish my father would have called an electrician at least more often, we'd have had to spend less nights without electricity that way. He'd end up burning something out, but at least he tried himself (and sometimes he even fried himself)!

Now I don't suggest you try and do your own wiring or anything (unless you're certified to do so), but we really need to get back to actually "doing" stuff. We need to get up off our collective asses and build things, modify stuff, tinker (as I've said in an editorial before as well).

So what's this anniversary issue really celebrating then? The ability within each of us, thanks to technology, to DO something. Don't just pick up this issue and read it passively, try out the things we're suggesting. Write in to us and tell us how they went. Send us pictures. Send us ideas for things you'd like to do and can't, and we'll try and figure out a cheap and inexpensive way of doing just that.

We're also going to ensure that this isn't a one-off for us either. We'll have more DO articles in every issue going forward, and we'd love to feature all the innovative things you've done as well.

Write in to us at do@digit.in for any or all of the above, and get off your butt and start doing already. 



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